Release Approval — [Project name]

Field	Entry
Project	[Project name]
Document	Release Approval
Version	[1.0]
Release candidate	[version / build hash]
Meeting date	[YYYY-MM-DD]
Chair	[Product owner]

Workflow gate: 6. UAT → 7. Deployment ("Approved"). Only the exact approved build is deployed.

1. Approval criteria

All items ticked = **Approved**. Open items with an agreed fix plan = **Approved with conditions**.

Quality (Test Plan)

- ☐ All test cases run; [95]%+ pass; every Must-requirement case passes
- ☐ Zero open critical defects; at most [n] major with workarounds
- ☐ Security, privacy and performance tests pass

Users (UAT Plan)

- ☐ All UAT scenarios pass
- ☐ Ratings at or above pass averages

Changes (Feedback and Change Management)

- ☐ Every CR is Verified, Deferred or Rejected
- ☐ User-facing CRs passed their UAT re-check

Compliance

- ☐ Licences and attributions checked
- ☐ Release notes, user guide and support material complete

2. Evidence pack

Shared at least [2] working days before the meeting.

Item	Owner
Final test report and open defect list	QA lead
UAT report and sign-off record	Product owner
Change register	Product owner
Build version, hash and checksums	Lead developer
Licence and attribution list	Lead developer
Release notes	Product owner
Deployment and rollback plan	Lead developer
Support readiness	Support lead

3. Approvers and decisions

Approver	Confirms	Can block?
Product owner (final decision)	Business value, UAT result, accepted risks	Yes
QA lead	Test results meet criteria	Yes
Lead developer	Build is the tested one; deployment ready	Yes
Support lead	Users can get help	No (raises a condition)

Decision	Next step
Approved	Release freeze, then step 7, Deployment
Approved with conditions	Conditions fixed and verified by a set date, then deploy
Not approved	Change requests raised; fix sprint or re-spike; new meeting

A condition may never cover a critical defect or a security, privacy or licence problem.

4. Go / no-go meeting

Agenda (45 min): release candidate scope → QA results → UAT results → change register → deployment and support readiness → each approver's go / no-go → decision and record.

Rules: decide on the evidence pack only; mark each criterion Met / Not met / Condition; write down accepted risks; share the record the same day.

5. After approval

- Tag the approved build (for example `v1.0.0`); record checksums.
- Freeze: any later change is a new CR, new build and, unless class A, a new approval.

Condition	CR	Owner	Due	Verified by	Status

Handoff to Deployment: record signed; build and checksums handed over; release notes final; date and rollback owner agreed; support briefed.

6. Approval record

Field	Entry
Release version and build hash	
Quality / Users / Changes / Compliance criteria	Met / Not met / Condition
Open defects accepted	
CRs deferred	
Risks accepted, with reasons	
Conditions	
Decision	Approved / Approved with conditions / Not approved
Product owner signature and date	
QA lead signature and date	
Lead developer signature and date	

7. Change log

Version	Date	Change
1.0	[YYYY-MM-DD]	First version